

The Luke–McKinnon Line

Five generations of direct ancestry, graded by the record that supports it



Deeper still, and what remains open

GENERATIONS VI AND VII — THE DEEPEST PROVEN GROUND

Both reached on primary documents — a 1920 death certificate and a 1910 census page.

 Lucius L. Luke 9 Oct 1872 – 21 Jun 1920 <i>Georgia death certificate no. 18075, Irwin Co.</i>	16
 Richard Benjamin “R. B.” Luke 24 Dec 1853 – 2 Aug 1926 <i>Named on that certificate as “R B Luke” · Luke Cemetery, Coffee Co.</i>	32
 Jane (Janie Ruth) Yawn 1855 – 1943 <i>Named on that certificate as “Jane Yawn”</i>	33
 John Rickerson abt 1824 – 1912 <i>1910 census, Pearson: enumerated as “maternal grandfather”</i>	50
 John Luke 1787 – 1875 <i>Unsourced — the frontier edge of the tree</i>	64
 Telitha Jane Graves 1819 – 1896 <i>Unsourced — note the 21-year gap against John’s birth</i>	65

RESOLVED: John J. Luke (1876–1939, m. Julia Mims 1904, Luke Cemetery) was R. B. Luke’s son — which makes him Jack’s UNCLE, not his father. He can come off the “possibly unrelated” list.

THE FOUR LARGE SIBLING GROUPS

Their obituaries are what proved the generation above them.

Children of Jack & Nealie Luke — 15

Richard Cleo Sr. (half-brother, by Clyde McMillan) · Versa Mae Law · Inez Crosby · Doris Merritt · Lucious · Dorothy Lee Callaway · James · Curtis · John Wesley Jr. · Jewel Faye Moore · Voncile Cavender · Ottis · ELMER PARKER · Butler · Brenda Jewell

Children of Monroe & Mary Jane McKinnon — 12

Edward · Harvey · Willie Mae · Louise Maulden · Arlen Sr. · Randall · ANDREW · Betty Jean Soles · Florene Phillips · Monroe Jr. · Bobby · Martha Denton

Children of Jesse & Mattie Hall — 11+

Myrtle Shook · Henry · Mitchell · "Pete" · Jesse James “Buck” · Lorraine · Chester · Joe “Bud” Ronald · SALLY RUDINE · Judy Luke · Shirley Griner · Myrtice Brown

Children of Joe Edd & Sallie Mae Giddens — 9

Louell Bowen · Ernest · Luther Robert · Mary Rau · Fred · Jo Ann Snipes · LUCILLE · Jerry & Larry (twins, d. infancy)

Names in capitals are your direct ancestors.

WHAT IS STILL UNPROVEN

Ranked by what each would unlock.

- 01

✓

Does Jack Luke belong to Lucius & Narcisus?

ANSWERED. He is in their household twice — “John,” age 3, in the 1900 Irwin County census, and “John C W Luke,” age 12, in 1910.
- 02

✓

Were George Albert & Martha really Monroe’s parents?

ANSWERED. 1910 census, Pearson: Monroe, age 9, son of “Art” McKinnon — with John Rickerson enumerated as “maternal grandfather.”
- 03

✓

Who were Nealie Hinton’s parents?

Mother ANSWERED: Abigail “Abby” Johns, a widow of 26 heading a Levy County, Florida household in 1910 with “Neal,” age 2. Father still probable.
- 04

✓

Dorothy and Doris Luke

BOTH FOUND. Dorothy in the 1930 household, born Florida abt 1927. Doris Kathleen Luke Merritt, 17 Nov 1931 – 15 Apr 2002, Center Hill, Florida.
- 05

Did Clyde McMillan marry Jack — or his brother William?

New, and it matters. The 1918 index reads “LUKE, JOHNNIE,” but a 1920 census entry pairs a Clyde Luke, 18, with a Wm L Luke. If it was William, Cleo is Jack’s nephew, not his half-brother.
- 06

Where and when did Jack and Nealie marry?

The window has tightened: both eldest daughters born in Florida (1927, 1928), Inez born Irwin County July 1930. Look in LEVY COUNTY, FLORIDA, abt 1924–27 — not Georgia.
- 07

Did Andrew McKinnon serve in the Army?

This family’s obituaries omit service — Arlen’s does, despite a VA marker. Order the file: Coffee Co. Clerk of Superior Court (free), then SF-180 to NPRC (\$70).
- 08

Martha Ricketson’s birth year

Headstone says 15 June 1864; the 1910 census implies abt 1872. Eight years apart, unresolved. Her relationship to Monroe is settled either way.

SIX CEMETERIES HOLD YOUR PEOPLE

Brushy Creek Primitive Baptist Luke Cemetery	Ocilla, Irwin Co. — Jack, Nealie, John Wesley Jr., Lucius, Narcisus
Lax Cemetery	Coffee Co. — R. B. Luke, John J. Luke
Willacoochee City Cemetery	Coffee Co. — Lucious, Versa Mae, Curtis, Brenda
Mora Cemetery	Atkinson Co. — Inez Luke Crosby
Arna Primitive Baptist	Coffee Co. — Andrew, Arlen Sr., Monroe Jr.
Carver Baptist · Sweetwater UMC	Atkinson Co. — Monroe Sr., Mary Jane, George Albert, Martha Douglas & Pearson — the Carvers and the Giddenses